



Ewe ati Egbo

UK BOTANICAL MARKETPLACE



Investment & Acquisition Brief · 2026

The trusted rail for African botanicals.

A verified marketplace **and freight network** moving traditional herbs from African producers and diaspora sellers to customers across the United Kingdom — safely, legally, and at a margin.

~2.5M+

UK DIASPORA

2 takes

PER ORDER

Live

WORKING DEMO

"Ewe ati Egbo" — Yoruba for *leaves and roots*. Confidential.

The whole thing in 10 seconds

Millions of people in the UK cook, heal, and keep culture alive with African herbs. Buying them is a nightmare — scattered across WhatsApp, Instagram, corner shops and suitcase importers, with no trust, no labels, and shipping that barely works.

We fixed the boring, expensive, hard part — getting product from Africa to a UK doorstep, verified and legal — and wrapped a beautiful marketplace around it.

Sellers list. Customers buy in their own language ("ewuro", "onugbu", or *Vernonia amygdalina* — all the same leaf). Our own cargo arm and a network of onboarded cargo agents move the goods. We take a cut of the **product** and a cut of the **shipping**. Two revenue lines on every single order.

Why anyone should care

It's a real market, underserved

A large, loyal diaspora buying weekly — and no one has given them a trusted, structured home to buy from.

The moat is operational

Anyone can copy a storefront. A working cross-border freight + compliance network is slow and expensive to rebuild. That's what a buyer pays a premium for.

It already exists

Not a slide deck. A working app with real search, a compliance engine (74 passing tests), a backend, and a public live demo you can open right now.

It scales sideways

The same rail replicates into US and EU diaspora corridors. Build once, relay everywhere.

Buying African herbs in the UK is broken

The demand is not in question. The *experience* is.

Today a customer who wants bitter leaf, prekese, moringa or black soap hunts across a dozen disconnected places — and takes on all the risk themselves:

- **No trust.** Who is this seller? Is the product what they say? If it never arrives, who do you call?
- **No information.** Wrong names, no ingredients, no origin, no storage or safety guidance.
- **No compliance.** Some products are food, some are cosmetics, some are medicines — and UK law treats each differently. Most informal sellers don't know, and don't care, until it becomes a problem.
- **Broken logistics.** The genuinely hard part is moving product from Africa to the UK reliably, legally and affordably. This is where the pain — and the money — actually lives.

Everyone who has tried this built a prettier storefront. The storefront is the easy 20%. The unsolved 80% is the rail.

That gap is the opportunity. Whoever owns the trusted rail — the freight, the compliance, the verified supply — owns the category.

THE PRODUCT

One platform, four sides

A marketplace is only as strong as the sides it connects. We connect four — and the fourth is the one competitors ignore.

WHO	WHAT THEY GET
Customers (UK)	Discovery, multilingual search, trusted product pages, a cross-border delivery quote <i>before</i> they pay, and order tracking to the door.
Sellers (Africa & UK)	Verification, a storefront, a guided listing wizard that keeps them compliant, and payouts — without having to solve shipping or UK law themselves.
Cargo agents	Our own arm <i>plus</i> onboarded third parties. They set routes and rates on corridors, receive consignments, update tracking, and get paid per leg.
Us (platform)	We verify everyone, enforce compliance, route the freight, split the money, and take a margin on both product and shipping.

The cargo-agent side is the quiet superpower. It turns shipping from a cost we tolerate into a network we own.

What it feels like to use

A customer types a word from home — “**ewuro**” — and instantly sees verified bitter leaf, correctly named, with a badge that says a real person stands behind it and a claims-check that says it makes no illegal promises. They see “**Lagos → London · 5–9 days · £12**” before they commit. They tap buy. We do the rest.

The moat: four layers deep

A pretty app is not a business. Here's what actually stops the next person from copying us.

LAYER	WHY IT'S HARD TO COPY
Logistics network	Onboarded cargo agents, proven corridors, customs know-how, consolidation. It compounds with volume and is slow & costly to rebuild from zero.
Compliance rail	Product-class rules + UK import handling done <i>for</i> the seller. This is the barrier that keeps informal competitors informal.
Botanical data	A proprietary vernacular ↔ botanical dictionary across Yoruba, Igbo, Hausa and more — and an SEO magnet no generic marketplace has.
Verified trust	Two-sided liquidity of verified sellers and buyers — the classic marketplace cold-start advantage, once seeded.

Consolidation is where the money hides: many small parcels on one corridor become one cheap consignment. The more volume, the wider the moat — and the fatter the margin.

The part that scares everyone else is our feature

Herbal products in the UK are not one legal category. Get it wrong and you're an illegal pharmacy. We built the rules into the software so a seller *can't* get it wrong.

Every product is one of four classes

CLASS	EXAMPLES	ROUTE
A • Herb/botanical	Bitter leaf, prekese, moringa	Food / general law (FSA)
B • Supplement	Capsules, powders, tinctures	Food supplement (no disease claims)
C • Cosmetic	Black soap, shea, oils	UK cosmetics (OPSS)
D • Medicine	Anything sold "to treat"	MHRA — closed by default

The claims engine (this is the magic)

When a seller writes a listing, our engine scans it. Say "cures malaria and treats fibroids" and it is **blocked** — instantly, with the reason. Ingredients run through a traffic-light list:

-  green — listable
-  amber — review
-  red — blocked

74 automated tests keep this honest — including a check that a seller can never quietly downgrade a risky herb to look harmless. Trust, provable in code.

Note: our classification is a design input; a UK-qualified regulatory/customs adviser signs off each class and corridor before launch. That review is scoped, not skipped.

IT'S BUILT

Real engineering, not vapourware

Most brands at this stage have a deck. We have a running product you can open on your phone.

Shared engine

Domain types, multilingual search, and the compliance engine live in one tested package — reused by app and backend. 74 tests, all green.

Owned backend

Fastify + PostgreSQL. Catalog, search and compliance APIs. Portable and not vendor-locked — the right shape for an asset you intend to sell.

Mobile + web app

One Expo codebase for iOS, Android and web. Photography-led, responsive, animated — verified-seller trust cues throughout.

Botanical dataset

A curated, categorised, compliance-flagged dictionary of Nigerian/Yoruba herbs — the seed of a data moat that grows with every tradition added.

Open the live demo: gbadebomotunrayo.github.io/Ewe-ati-egbo — search a herb in Yoruba, watch it resolve, and see the trust panel on a product page.

Two takes on every order

A pure marketplace earns once. We earn twice — because we own the shipping.

STREAM	DETAIL
Product commission	8–12% of each sale
Logistics margin	Markup on freight + consolidation spread — the fat line
Cargo-agent fee	A platform cut on legs routed to third-party agents
Subscriptions / featured (later)	Seller tiers, promoted listings
Wholesale & data (later)	B2B corridors; demand data; the rail itself, licensable

One order, illustratively

£30 product + £12 delivery = **£42 paid**. Commission ≈ £3. Delivery margin ≈ £4. **Platform gross ≈ £7+ per order** — while the seller and the cargo agent are also paid. The delivery line, not the commission, is where a durable margin lives, and it's defensible because we own the rail.

Double the revenue-per-order of a normal marketplace, in a niche the giants ignore. That's the fundable sentence.

Big lane, real start, clear next step

The market

Beachhead: the West African & Caribbean UK diaspora (~2.5M+), buying herbs, teas, foods and natural beauty every week. Then more African origins, then the same engine into **US and EU diaspora corridors**. Reusable assets: the rail, the compliance engine, the dataset.

What exists today (honestly)

- Working app (iOS/Android/web) with a **public live demo**.
- Compliance engine v2 with 74 passing tests; owned Fastify/Postgres backend.
- Curated, compliance-flagged botanical dataset.
- Full product, market, logistics and compliance documentation.
- Not yet: real sellers onboarded, payments live, first corridor run. That's exactly what the next step funds.

Why now — the exit thesis

An acquirer buys **infrastructure**: a working cross-border freight network, a compliant import pipeline, two-sided liquidity, and a proprietary dataset. Natural buyers — diaspora fintech/logistics players, ethnic-foods distributors, marketplace consolidators — pay premiums for operational moats. This is one.

The ask: capital to seed one corridor (sellers + 1–2 cargo agents) and run 100 real end-to-end orders — proving the rail and the unit economics. Everything is sequenced around that proof.

Let's talk. · Ewe ati Egbo — leaves and roots, moved with trust.